Lesson plan · for the teacher

Check its work

AI agents · Level 2 · Lesson 3

Time
40 min

Materials
Ten cards, each with a request and the call an agent proposed (some with planted slips); A poster of the checker's five rules; Red and green markers or stickers; A notebook for the log

Learning goals

- Check a call before it runs, not just the answer.
- Apply five strict rules to proposed calls.
- Keep a record of what ran and who said yes.

Activity: Be the checker

1. Warm-up (5 min): Write the library reminder and the call the agent proposed on the board. Ask: what went wrong, and when could someone have stopped it?
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that the moment to check is after the call is written and before it runs. Put up the five rules and go through one example card together.
3. Be the checker (15 min): Each group gets ten cards. For each card they check every rule, mark it green or red, and write the rule that stopped it. Actions that pass need the leader's signature.
4. The log (7 min): One pupil per group copies each decision into the log: card, decision, rule, who signed. Compare two groups' logs: did they agree?
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Ask which slip was hardest to spot and why. Agree that the checker can be simple but can never be skipped. Then give the exit ticket.

Prepare ten cards before the lesson, about a third with planted slips: a class that doesn't exist, a time like 25:00, a misspelt word. Use made-up names only.

Discussion

- Why is the answer too late to check?
- Which of the five rules would you never switch off?
- Who at our school should read the agent's log?

Exit ticket

- Write one proposed call with a slip in it, and the rule that stops it.

Try it at school tomorrow
Play "Be the checker": groups apply the five rules to proposed calls on cards, some with planted slips, and stop or pass each one. One pupil keeps a log of what passed, what was stopped and who signed.

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1 **The checker passes a reminder for tomorrow at 8:00. Who should decide whether it is set?**

- ◯ The model: it asked for it
- ◯ A person: a reminder is an action
- ◯ The checker: it passed the rules

2 **The request was "Remind me tomorrow at 9:00 to tidy the library." The agent proposed this call. Which checks does it fail? Choose all that apply.**

```
reminder{"text":"tisums the library",
         "when":"tomorrow 25:00"}
```

- ☐ The tool is switched on
- ☐ It is the right tool for the job
- ☐ Every word and number comes from the request
- ☐ Every detail has the right shape

3 **Put in order what happens to a call in a well-built agent app.**

- ☐ The checker applies its rules
- ☐ A person approves the action
- ☐ The model writes a call
- ☐ The log records what ran and who approved it
- ☐ The app runs the tool

4 **A checker has to be as clever as the model to catch the model's mistakes.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

5 **Match each proposed call to the rule that stops it.**

The timetable for 9C, when you asked about 9Z	• • • •	Every detail has the right shape
A reminder at 25:00	• • • •	The tool is switched on
A reminder after the timetable said "no school"	• • • •	Every name comes from your words or a result
The weather, while the weather tool is off	• • • •	No step before it failed

✎ **Which agent action at your school would you most want a checker for, and which of the five rules would catch the most likely slip?**

Check your answers

Check its work

1. **A person: a reminder is an action**

   The rules catch slips, but a reminder is an action, so a person gives the final yes.

2. **Every word and number comes from the request; Every detail has the right shape**

   “tisums” and 25:00 are not in the request, and 25:00 isn’t a time: two rules stop it.

3. **Top to bottom: 2, 3, 1, 5, 4**

   The check comes after the call is written and before anything runs; the person’s yes comes before the action; and the log records what really happened.

4. **False**

   Simple, strict rules catch slips like 9C or 25:00 without understanding anything, and they never guess.

5. **The timetable for 9C, when you asked about 9Z — Every name comes from your words or a result**
   A reminder at 25:00 — Every detail has the right shape
   A reminder after the timetable said “no school” — No step before it failed
   The weather, while the weather tool is off — The tool is switched on

   Each slip breaks one rule: a name from nowhere, a detail in an impossible shape, a step built on a failure, a tool that isn’t allowed.